The goal of implementing a data mesh is to extract more value from the company's data assets. That is also the reason we keep this definition so lightweight and inclusive in relation to the level at which each principle is followed. The following nontechnical use case of a data mesh will hopefully explain what we mean by that.

1.2 Why the data mesh?

We see three main reasons that the data world is in need of decentralization in the form of the data mesh:

- With the proliferation of data sources and data consumers, a central team in between creates an organizational bottleneck.
- With multiple data-emitting and -consuming technologies, a central monolithic data storage in between creates a technological bottleneck, which loses a lot of the information in this step in the middle.
- Both data quality and data ownership are only implicitly assigned, which causes confusion and a lack of control over both.

Over the past 30 years, most data architectures were designed to integrate multiple data sources; that is, central data teams merged data from all kinds of source systems and provided harmonized sets to users, who in turn tried to use them to drive business value. Yet, for over a decade now, the problem of big-data hangovers has plagued companies of all sizes. These data environments struggle with the scalability of the solutions, incompleteness of the data, accessibility problems, and the like. We bet that your company is also fighting to extract value from data, right?

Some approaches simply seem to not work out. Dozens of reports and dashboards seem to be of no use compared to the costs of creating and maintaining them. A bunch of data science projects seem to stay stuck in the *prototype* phase, and data-intensive applications that are running are probably facing a bunch of data-related problems. At least it seems that way, considering the effort it takes to get a software component to run.